

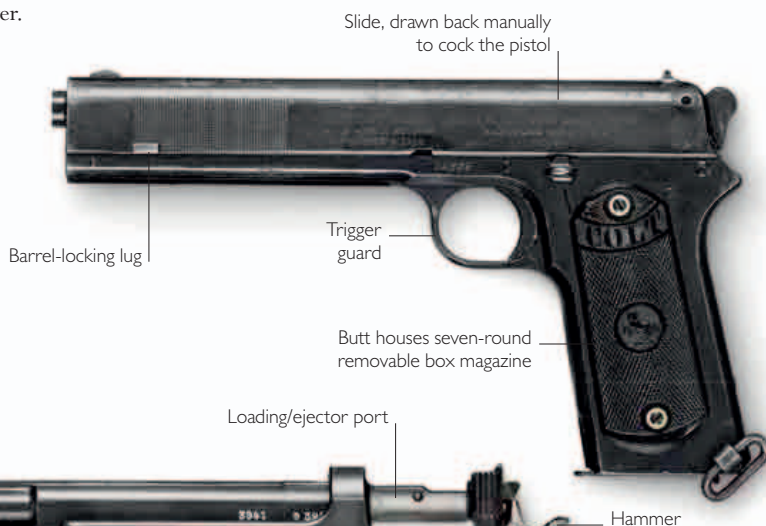
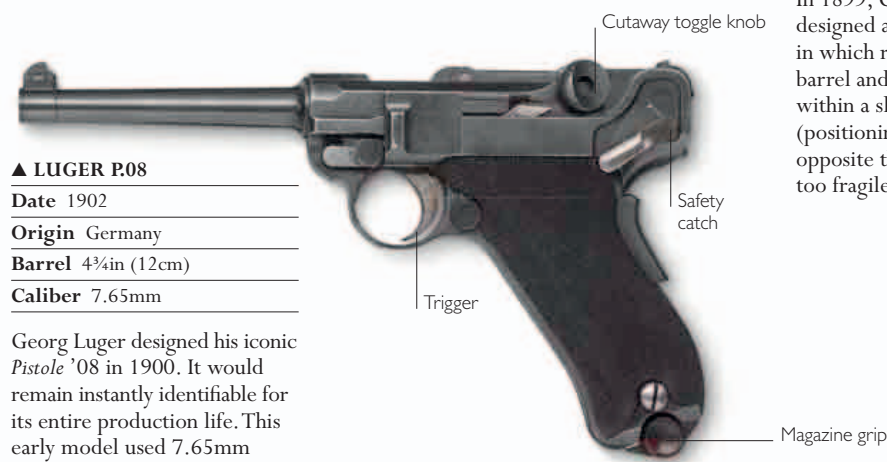
SELF-LOADING PISTOLS (1901–24)

This period saw the appearance of several designs of self-loading pistol that are still familiar today. John Browning created a series of slide-action pistols produced by Colt, culminating in the Model 1911A1, which was carried by American forces through both world wars. Georg Luger perfected the toggle-bolt breech mechanism of Hugo Borchardt to produce the pistol which became the ubiquitous German military sidearm. Other pistols, while technically interesting, proved less successful.

▲ LUGER P08

Date 1902
Origin Germany
Barrel 4¾in (12cm)
Caliber 7.65mm

Georg Luger designed his iconic *Pistole '08* in 1900. It would remain instantly identifiable for its entire production life. This early model used 7.65mm ammunition, which lacked stopping power.



◀ COLT MODEL 1902

Date 1902
Origin US
Barrel 6in (15.2cm)
Caliber .38in ACP

Browning produced a series of successful locked-breech pistols for the military market. However, the Model 1902 was not as popular. This gun featured a double-link mechanism. Its barrel was connected to the pistol frame at each end via pivoting links, which locked the barrel and slide together until the bullet left the muzzle.



▲ STEYR M1905

Date 1905
Origin Austria-Hungary
Barrel 6½in (16cm)
Caliber 7.63mm Mannlicher

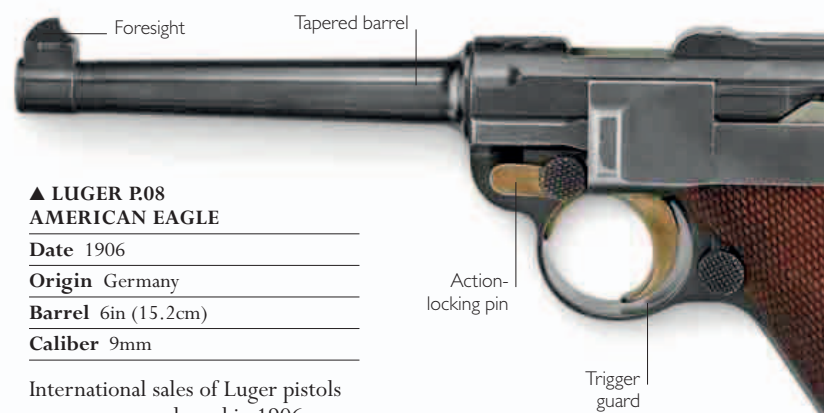
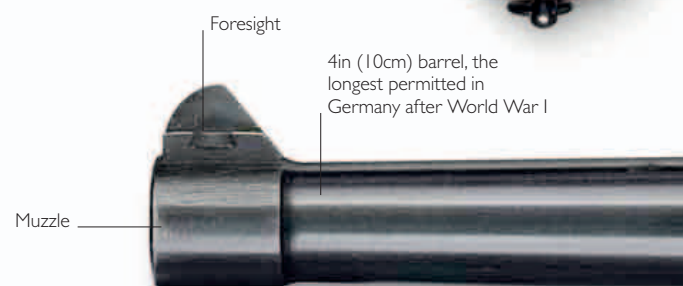
The M1905, designed by Austrian manufacturer Steyr-Mannlicher (see pp.290–91), was chambered for a round generally thought too powerful for a recoil action, but succeeded due to the high standard to which it was manufactured. This pistol was never especially popular though.



▲ WEBLEY-FOSBERY

Date 1901
Origin UK
Barrel 7½in (19cm)
Caliber .455in

In 1899, Colonel George Fosbery designed a self-cocking revolver in which recoil propelled the barrel and cylinder backward within a slide, indexing the cylinder (positioning each chamber in turn opposite the firing pin). It proved too fragile for battlefield conditions.



▲ LUGER P08 AMERICAN EAGLE

Date 1906
Origin Germany
Barrel 6in (15.2cm)
Caliber 9mm

International sales of Luger pistols grew enormously and in 1906, new models, in 9mm caliber, included one for commercial sale in the US. This finely finished version had the manufacturer's mark (DWM) and also an American eagle on the top of the receiver.